VIT BHOPAL

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PROJECT REPORT

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Introduction

In the contemporary digital landscape, the acquisition of robust digital literacy competencies is imperative for the academic community. This initiative was undertaken to facilitate a comprehensive understanding of digital tool optimization, professional communication standards, and the maintenance of online security. Serving in the capacity of a Student Digital Ambassador, the primary responsibility involves mentoring peers in the responsible and efficient navigation of the digital sphere. Throughout this project, engagement with platforms such as GitHub and LinkedIn, alongside various coding environments, was central to the development of essential resources, including informational infographics, professional correspondence, and cybersecurity frameworks. These practical exercises have significantly bolstered technical proficiency and heightened awareness of communication etiquette and safety protocols. Ultimately, the insights gained through this project provide a foundational framework for success in academic, professional, and future career endeavors.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For Task 1, I created a digital literacy awareness infographic using Adobe Express. The aim of the infographic was to explain the concept of digital literacy and highlight its importance for students. In my design, I included topics such as the meaning of digital literacy, safe internet practices, email etiquette, and useful digital tools. The infographic was designed in a simple and visually appealing way so that it could be easily understood by students. I used icons, headings, and short points to make the content clear and engaging. One interesting part of this task was exploring different design elements in Adobe Express, such as templates, fonts, and color combinations. However, choosing the right layout and organizing the content in a limited space was slightly challenging. Overall, this task helped me understand how to present information visually and effectively, which is an important skill in today's digital world.

Task 2: Student Digital Portfolio

For my project, I selected GitHub and LinkedIn based on their unique capabilities in code management, professional networking, and code support. GitHub is a version control system for managing code repositories, collaborative coding, and profile pages for showcasing code. LinkedIn is a professional networking site. On this site, students and professionals can connect. Moreover, they can share their achievements and look for internship and job opportunities. Over the course of the next 4 years , I aim to utilize the above mentioned tools in the following manners :

GitHub:- To actively maintain my presence on GitHub by making regular commits and open-source contributions, enhance my coding skills, and develop a strong portfolio.

LinkedIn:- To develop my professional profile, expand my network, and stay updated with various opportunities in my field.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For Task 3, I utilized HackerRank and Google Workspace to demonstrate both technical proficiency and collaborative digital leadership. On HackerRank, I completed foundational Python challenges to validate my coding syntax and logic, which are essential for my ongoing coursework. For the collaborative component, I developed a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. This involved creating a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer questions to engage my peers on critical topics.

Academically, these tools are indispensable for my growth. HackerRank provides a structured environment to practice competitive coding and prepare for technical interviews, while Google Forms linked to Google Sheets for real-time response analysis, enables efficient data collection for research and group projects. By integrating these tools, I am better equipped to manage academic data securely and contribute to a "culture of digital hygiene" within the university.

Task 4: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Within the contemporary digital ecosystem, deficient communication strategies frequently precipitate profound misunderstandings and suboptimal professional perceptions. For instance, correspondence directed toward academic faculty that lacks a precise subject line, formal salutation, or a professional cadence may be interpreted as unprofessional, thereby diminishing the likelihood of a constructive response. To mitigate such occurrences, it is imperative to adhere to established email etiquette, which encompasses the formulation of lucid subject headers, the utilization of refined language, and the implementation of logical message architectures. Furthermore, rigorous proofreading remains a foundational requirement to eliminate erroneous content prior to transmission. By refining these communicative competencies, individuals can cultivate a distinguished digital presence and ensure the efficacious delivery of their intended objectives.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

While researching the rise of cybercrime in India, I was most surprised by the sheer scale and rapid escalation of the threat, with reported cases jumping from 44,511 in 2019 to 52,430 in 2021. It was eye-opening to learn that over 27 million Indian adults faced cyber theft in a single year, often due to "social engineering and email spoofing". This highlighted that even media-savvy youth are highly vulnerable if they lack specific digital literacy skills.

As a result, the one habit I will personally change is my use of public Wi-Fi in places like railway stations and cafes. Learning that these networks are susceptible to "man-in-the-middle attacks," where hackers can easily intercept personal information, has made me prioritize security over convenience. Moving forward, I will strictly use mobile data for sensitive academic or financial tasks to maintain better "digital hygiene".

Conclusion

In conclusion, this project helped me develop essential digital literacy skills required in today's world. I learned how to use digital tools, communicate professionally, and stay safe online. Each task contributed to improving my understanding of different aspects of digital life. This project also highlighted the importance of maintaining a professional online presence and being responsible while using the internet. The knowledge gained from this project will be useful in my academic journey as well as in my future career.

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